

1.d) Etic vs Emic approach of study

Etic approach focusses on the external factor. It does not go to the deeper and inner layer of analysis of culture.

Merits

- ① Aims to generalise
- ② Gives the cross cultural analysis factor.
- ③ It is universal and permanent idea
- ④ Based on objectivity and rationality

Demerits

- ① It overlooks the deeper layers.
- ② No subjectivity.
- ③ excess focus on structure, objectivity
- ④ Here the individual agency is sidelined.

Example of Etic approach

- ① Marvin Harris idea of cultural Materialism is based on etic approach, wherein infrastructure

will change the structure and super-structure

② classical evolutionist gave the terms like Savagery, Barbarism by being in arm chair.

Emic approach :-> focus on the inner meanings and deeper layers.

Merits

- ① Subjectivity
- ② Contextual and differential meaning
- ③ Individual agency
- ④ Based on mental structures.

Demerits

- ① lacks the universality
- ② It cannot be generalised.
- ③ Too much subjectivity can lead to data manipulation.

Example => Geertz study of the Balinese cock fight; Franz Boas study of Kwakiutl; Malinowski - ~~taboo~~ taboo

Thus, the etic & emic approach both should be used consciously.